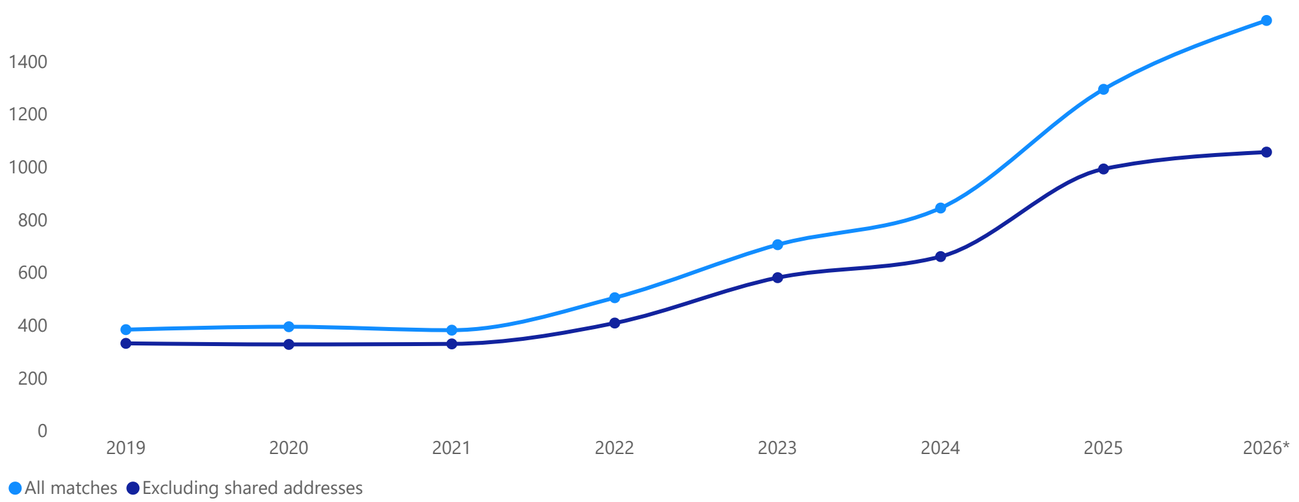
Firm formation rose about threefold from 2019 to 2025, even after removing shared addresses

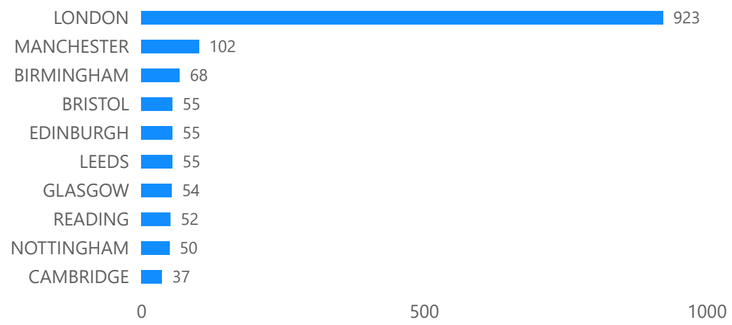
New live firms by year of incorporation.



2026* runs to 1 November 2026. Live companies only

London is about one in five firms; Manchester leads the rest

Registered address, firms incorporated 2019 onward

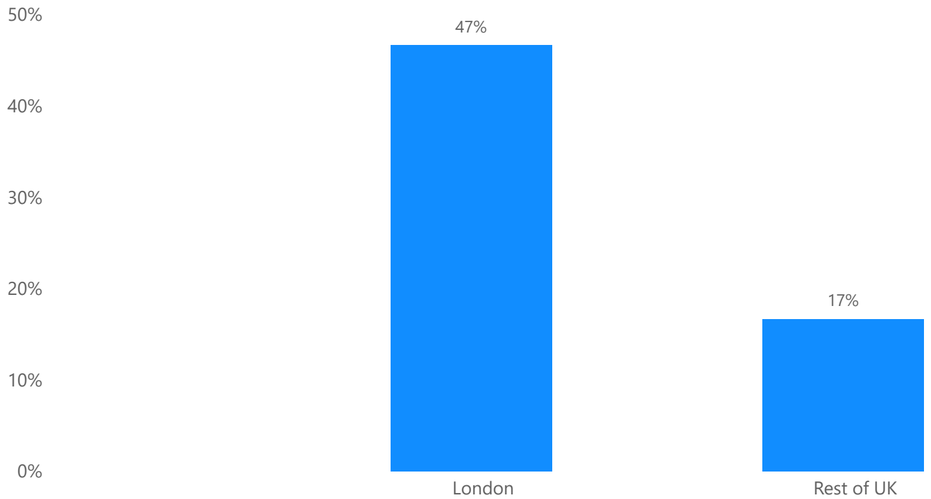


Registered address, not where people work

source: Companies House free company data snapshot, 1 November 2026; own analysis

14 of 30 sampled London firms showed a working business, against 5 of 30 elsewhere

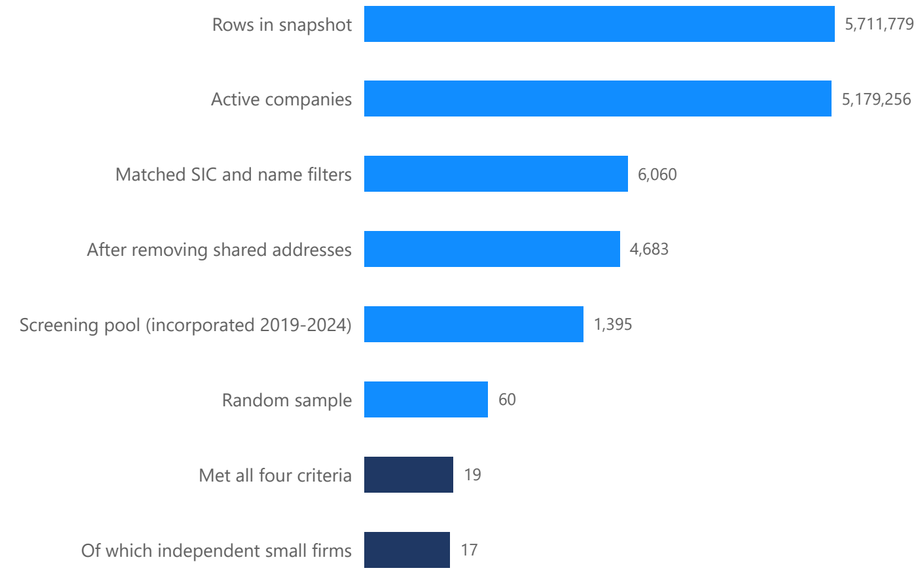
Share of the 30 sampled firms in each area that met all four criteria



Rest of UK includes outer-London towns

From 5.7 million companies to 17 independent small firms

Firms at each stage of the study



Bar lengths use a logarithmic scale

source: Companies House free company data snapshot, 1 November 2026; own analysis